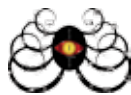




Android Wear 2.0 fix

A Reddit user found out that turning off "Ok Google" detection fixes lag issues on Android Wear 2.0 <http://digit.in/AWear20k>



Botnet zombies routers

Satori IoT botnet, based on the source code of Mirai botnet, exploits zero-day to zombie Huawei routers <http://digit.in/ZombieRtr>

ASUS ROG STRIX GL503 SCAR Edition

Built for FPS gaming

With plenty of fish in the gaming laptop market, brands have now resorted to launching laptop SKUs tailored for specific game genres. We believe this to be the natural evolution of the laptop market. Since these units target the enthusiast gamers, brands need to provide something competitive to what the desktop has to offer. There you can switch out any component to ensure that you get the extra edge when it comes to competitive esports. ASUS has done the same with new GL503 SCAR and HERO Edition. The two laptops are essentially the same configuration, with the SCAR built for FPS titles and the HERO built for MOBA titles.

Build

The overall build of the SCAR and HERO is the same as we mentioned. We only got the SCAR for review so that's what we know inside out. Both units have a distinct appearance like we've never seen before. The SCAR has a very brushed aluminium finish on the top with a sharp edge running diagonally across the panel. On the inside, we see a lot of carbon fibre texture giving the unit quite a distinctive feel. Coming down to the keyboard, we have the entire keyboard assembly sitting in a slightly recessed chassis with the WASD keys having a different styling to make it stand out. We should point out that on the HERO edition, the QWER keys are the ones made to stand out for their prevalence in MOBA titles. They touchpad has minute gradations along the edges, giving it a look akin to an HUD.

On the underside, we find the RAM, M.2 SSD and HDD being easily



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accessible. Upon popping the chassis open, we see a twin fan cooling assembly, however, some of the heat-pipes are shared between

the CPU and the GPU. The M.2 SSD does not come with a heatsink as we've started to see in more gaming laptops. The audio solution seems to be very standard and the I/O ports are plenty. We'd have liked to see the chassis around the I/O to be a bit more thicker than what it is.

Features

There's always ASUS Gamefirst for all your configuration needs in a central location. This includes the load lines for the cooling fans, RGB patterns and overclocking profiles. We noticed that the GPU and CPU are set to stock frequencies on the GL503VM. Apparently, the GL503VD features a GTX 1050 with a 100 MHz factory overclock. However, that's not needed with the GTX 1060 since it's more than capable of churning out insane amount of frames in FPS titles.

The SCAR has a 5ms response time TN panel rated for 120 Hz refresh rate. Having tried our hands on 120 Hz, 144 Hz, 165 Hz and 240 Hz panels, we can confidently say that this will give you

a certain edge, especially with G-Sync turned on. Playing Overwatch and CS:GO on this machine really feels different compared to a 60 Hz panel. Then there is the cooling system which can be ramped up by simply pressing Fn+F5 anytime you need it.

Performance

Like most 7700HQ + GTX 1060 laptops out there, the SCAR did not disappoint. We managed to get 5446 points in PCMark 10 Extended run and 3675 points in 3DMark Time Spy. FireStrike Ultra scored 2656 points and when it comes to gaming we were seeing around 91 FPS in DOOM on Ultra and in Rise of the Tomb Raider we saw upwards of 62 FPS. However, this is the SCAR and therefore, we focused more on FPS titles.

Rainbow Six Siege easily churned out around 112 FPS and Overwatch was about the same.

Moving on to the other components, the M.2 SSD managed to eke out 3303 MBps in sequential read while write speeds were about 1200 MBps. Even the Wi-Fi adapter ran just fine with no significant latency issues.

Verdict

Manufacturers can hardly bring about a difference when it comes to gaming laptops since every brand has the exact same configuration out there. So it's now come down to giving gamers a more personalised experience with hardware that's suited for their gaming genres. The GL503VM SCAR is certainly a step in that direction with the customised keyboard and low-response time TN panel. And with it's lucrative pricing, we believe gamers will find ASUS's unique offering to be more attractive than the competition.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7 7700HQ | PLATFORM: HM175 | RAM: 16 GB 2400 MHz | SCREEN SIZE: 15.6-inches | SCREEN RESOLUTION: 1920x1080 | GPU: 1060 6 GB | SSD: 256 GB | HDD: 1 TB 7200 RPM | AC ADAPTER: 180 W | WEIGHT: 2.5 kg

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